a FlexLifeFi K–12 program

GRADE 6 · LESSON PLANS

Ten Lessons, Ready to Teach

Standards, materials, procedure, differentiation — pick up Monday.

Year theme: Businesses Need Systems and Roles

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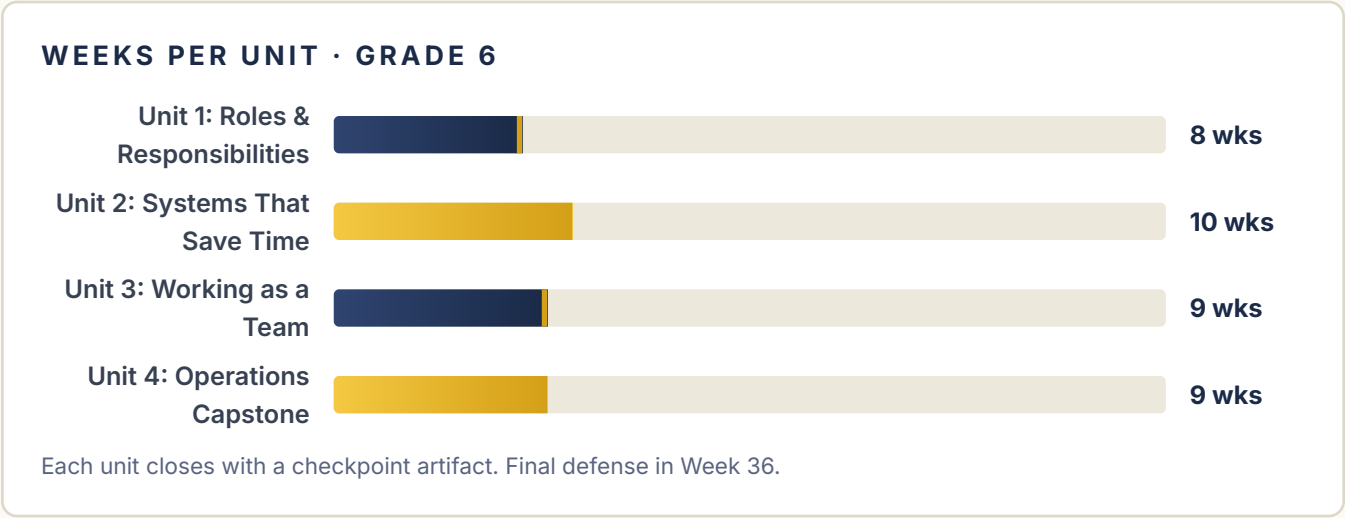
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 6 · LESSON PLANS

Ten Lessons, Ready to Teach

Most adults run their lives without a system. You won't.

Ten fully fleshed lessons spanning the year. Each lesson is built to pass the picks-up-Monday test: a teacher with no prior prep should be able to read this Sunday night and teach it Monday morning. Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Differentiation notes are specific and actionable. Vocabulary is included for each lesson. Time blocks default to 50 minutes (single middle-school period) unless noted; longer blocks are flagged.

Lessons are sampled across the year so the full arc is visible:

1. (Week 1) Cash V1 launch + What is a value chain?
2. (Week 5) Customer segments — three things you know
3. (Week 8) Value Chain + Segment Pack — Checkpoint 1 Studio Day
4. (Week 11) SOPs — write the recipe
5. (Week 14) The monthly ledger and the savings rate
6. (Week 18) Systems Pack — Checkpoint 2 Studio Day
7. (Week 21) RACI — who does what, who decides
8. (Week 25) Legal but sketchy — drawing the ethics line
9. (Week 31) The 5 Whys — past the first answer
10. (Week 36) Capstone Defense Day

Lesson 1 — What is a Value Chain?

"Listening is not a moment. It's a system."

— CASH

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Where the value comes from **Topic area:** Business awareness · value chain mapping

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define the four nodes of a simple value chain — supplier, producer, seller, customer.
- Map the value chain for one familiar local business with at least one example at each node.

Standards alignment

- **C3 D2.Eco.6.6-8:** Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices. (Anchored in seeing the supply side of a real chain.)

- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts to examine a topic — applied to a one-paragraph value-chain caption.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize one's own knowledge and gaps about how things actually work.

Materials

- Cash Video #1 ("A business is a system, not just a storefront") — 2:45.
- Capstone Journal (notebook), one per student.
- A printed image of a simple food product (e.g., a pizza slice, a granola bar) — projected or one per pair.
- Chart paper and markers, one set per pair.
- A 3-foot strip of butcher paper labeled left-to-right: Supplier · Producer · Seller · Customer.

Vocabulary

- **Supplier** — the person or business that provides a raw material.
- **Producer** — the person or business that turns the raw material into a product.
- **Seller** — the person or business that hands the product to the customer.
- **Customer** — the person who pays and uses the product.
- **Value chain** — the path the product takes from raw to handed-over.

Procedure

1. Engage — Cash Video + One Question (~7 min)

Play Cash Video #1. As students watch, post the prompt on the board:

> *"Think about a slice of pizza. Where did it start? Walk it backwards in your head."*

Pair-share for 2 minutes. Cold-call two pairs to share the chain they built backwards.

2. Explore — Build the Pizza Chain Together (~10 min)

Project a slice of pizza. Walk it left to right on the butcher-paper strip:

- **Supplier:** wheat farmer, tomato farm, dairy farm.
- **Producer:** the pizza shop kitchen — flour and sauce and cheese become a pie.
- **Seller:** the cashier handing the slice over the counter.
- **Customer:** the kid eating it after soccer practice.

Surface the rule: a value chain is the path a product takes, with someone adding something at each step.

3. Explain — Vocabulary + the Norm (~6 min)

Define the five vocabulary words. Add to Vocabulary Spine. State the year's first norm: "In this room, when you say something about a business, you'll be asked: which people, and how do you know? You'll ask each other this. I'll ask. You'll get good at answering."

Tell them: this year is about how businesses actually run. Not the logo. The chain.

4. Apply — Map a Local Business (~20 min)

In pairs, each pair picks one local business they know (a coffee shop, a bike repair shop, a hair salon, a sandwich place). On chart paper, they sketch the four-node chain with at least one specific example at each node.

Confer with as many pairs as possible. Push back when an example is too vague: "the supplier" is not enough — which supplier? Coffee beans from where? Paper cups from a paper company? Push for specificity.

5. Close — Pin and Predict (~7 min)

Each pair tapes their chart to the wall. Class does a 3-minute silent gallery walk. Two volunteers share the most surprising node they saw. Tell them: in Week 8, you'll map the chain for your own venture.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a printed reference card with the four nodes and Spanish/Mandarin/Vietnamese cognates where applicable (Spanish: proveedor, productor, vendedor, cliente). Allow pairs to draw their chain with picture-only labels first; add written labels second.
- **IEP/504:** Pre-print the four-node strip on chart paper so the pair only needs to fill in the boxes. Allow verbal sharing to a partner before writing. Reduce the example count from "at least one at each node" to "at least one at any two nodes."
- **Advanced learners:** Push for a second layer — within the producer node, are there sub-steps? (E.g., a pizza shop has dough-prep, sauce-prep, assembly, baking, packaging.) Ask: "If one of these sub-steps got slow, what would the customer notice?" Sets up Unit 2's SOP work.

Assessment

Formative: Walk during pair work; check that students name specific examples, not categories. **Summative:** Pair charts feed Checkpoint 1 (Week 8) — students will map a chain for their own venture by then.

Closure

Same as #5 above.

Homework / Extension

In the Capstone Journal: pick a different real business. Sketch its four-node chain in 5 minutes. Bring Wednesday.

Teacher notes

- A student picks a "business" that isn't really a business (e.g., "the school"). Coach: "What does this place sell? Who pays? If it's free for the user, who pays for it to exist?" Useful — but leave the harder cases for Unit 1's later weeks.
- A student's chain has the same person at producer and seller (a baker who bakes and sells). Validate — that's a real configuration. Push: "What changes when those are the same person vs. when they're different people?" Foreshadows roles.

Lesson 2 — Customer Segments: Three Things You Know

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Where the value comes from **Topic area:** Customers, branding, marketing · segment thinking

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define a customer segment using at least three specific things known about that segment (age, where they hang out, what they care about).
- Distinguish a segment from a crowd, with one example of each.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts to examine a topic.
- **CCSS-Math 6.SP.B.5:** Summarize numerical data sets in relation to their context. (Light use — counting how many of "your segment" you actually know.)
- **CASEL Social Awareness:** Perspective-taking — central to early segment work.

Materials

- 6 printed cards, each with one customer description (some specific, some vague).
- Capstone Journal.
- A "Segment Sketch" template (provided in activity book).
- Chart paper labeled with two columns: SEGMENT · CROWD.

Vocabulary

- **Segment** — a group of customers who share specific things in common.
- **Crowd** — a vague big group ("kids," "teenagers") that's too broad to actually serve.
- **Demographic** — a category like age, grade, or where someone lives.

Procedure

1. Engage — Sort the Cards (~10 min)

Pass out the 6 cards face-up at the front. Read each aloud:

- "Kids." → crowd.
- "Sixth graders who walk to school and forget breakfast on game days." → segment.
- "Teens who play sports." → crowd.
- "Eighth-grade soccer players who have practice from 3:30 to 5:00 on Tuesdays." → segment.
- "People in my town." → crowd.
- "Adults who walk their dogs in the park between 6 and 7 a.m. on weekdays." → segment.

Tape each on the SEGMENT or CROWD column. After all six, ask: "What's the difference?" Pair-share, share-out 2 students.

Surface the rule: a segment names enough specifics that you could actually picture a person and find them.

2. Explain — The Three Things Rule (~7 min)

State it clean: "To call something a segment, you need at least three things you know about it. Age or grade is one. Where they hang out is two. What they care about is three. If you can't name three, you have a crowd."

Add the words to the Vocabulary Spine. Foreshadow: in Grade 7, you'll go even deeper and build a persona — but for now, three things is enough.

3. Explore — Practice on Two More (~10 min)

Students work in pairs on two examples in the activity book:

- A homework-help service.
- A weekend dog-walking business.

For each, pairs sketch a segment with three things known. Confer.

4. Apply — Segment Sketch for the Capstone (~18 min)

In the Capstone Journal, each student writes a Segment Sketch for their own venture (which they tentatively picked in Week 2):

- **My venture: _**
- **My customer segment:**
- Thing I know #1 (age or grade): _
- Thing I know #2 (where they hang out): _
- Thing I know #3 (what they care about): _
- **One thing I'm not sure about my segment: _**

Confer with 5–6 students; ask each: "Could you find this person? If so, where, and at what time?"

5. Close — Wall of Segments (~5 min)

Three volunteers read theirs aloud. Class scores each silently with thumbs-up if it sounds like a segment, sideways if it sounds like a crowd. End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a sentence frame: "My segment is ___ who hangs out at ___ and cares about ___." Allow native-language brainstorming before English finalization.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce from three things known to two for the first pass; add the third in a follow-up session. Provide pre-printed Segment Sketch with the three boxes already labeled.
- **Advanced learners:** Push for a fourth thing known — what frustrates this segment? Adds a behavioral detail and previews Grade 7's persona work directly.

Assessment

Formative: Pair work and conferring notes. **Summative:** Segment Sketch feeds Checkpoint 1 (Week 8).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Bring one example of a real ad you've seen this week and write: who is this ad's segment? List three things you can tell about them just from the ad.

Teacher notes

- A student says "my segment is everybody." Coach gently: "If it's everybody, who isn't it for? If you can't name someone it's not for, it's a crowd." That sentence is the year's lever.

- A student names a segment that sounds exclusionary ("popular kids only"). Use the sensitivity move: a segment can decline to serve someone (a teen brand isn't for grandparents — fine). It cannot be defined by who's "cool enough" — that's reproduction of cliques. Coach toward behavior-based specificity.

Lesson 3 — Value Chain + Segment Pack: Checkpoint 1 Studio Day

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 80 minutes (block — Checkpoint day) **Unit:** 1 — Where the value comes from **Topic area:** Synthesis · value chain · segment

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Produce a Value Chain + Segment Pack for their own venture: a four-node chain plus a three-things-known segment sketch.
- Defend the Pack in a 2-minute peer share, citing one specific detail at each node and one piece of evidence for the segment.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** Apply systematic decision making to a medium-term financial goal.
- **C3 D2.Eco.6.6-8:** Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices.
- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.6.4:** Present claims and findings, sequencing ideas logically.

Materials

- Value Chain template (4 boxes labeled).
- Segment Sketch template.
- Capstone Journal.
- Wall space for the class gallery.
- Customer Research rubric (Rubric Bank — Grades 4–6 simplified version).

Vocabulary

(All previously introduced — recycle. Reinforce: value chain, supplier, producer, seller, customer, segment.)

Procedure

1. Engage — Read the Rubric Aloud (~5 min)

Project the simplified Customer Research rubric. Read the 3 criteria aloud:

- Quality of evidence.
- Specificity of segment.
- Problem statement (light at this grade — one sentence).

Tell them: this is what you're being scored on. No surprises.

2. Build the Value Chain (~25 min)

Students work independently on their Value Chain template — for their own venture. Sections:

- **Supplier:** Where does the raw stuff come from? Name at least one specific supplier.
- **Producer:** Who turns the raw stuff into the product? (Often: the student.)
- **Seller:** Who hands it to the customer?
- **Customer:** Who pays and uses it? (Pull from Lesson 2's Segment Sketch.)

Confer with each student for 2 minutes.

3. Polish the Segment Sketch (~15 min)

Students revise the Segment Sketch from Lesson 2 with sharper specificity. Add:

- **One quote (real or imagined-but-realistic) from someone in the segment.** Example: "I always run out of pencils on the second day of the week."

Mini-lesson: a quote — even a realistic one — makes a segment feel like a person. Hedge: in Grade 7, you'll get real quotes from real interviews. For now, a realistic quote is enough.

4. Write the Caption (~15 min)

In the Capstone Journal, students write one paragraph (4–6 sentences) connecting their value chain to their segment:

> *"My venture is [_]. The chain starts with [supplier] who provides [_], goes to [producer], then [seller], and ends with [segment]. The thing my segment cares most about is [_ _ _ _], and that's why my venture exists."*

Confer.

5. Gallery Walk + Peer Share (~15 min)

Tape Packs to wall. Students walk silently for 5 minutes, leaving sticky-note feedback ("I see..." "I wonder..."). Then 4 students do a 2-minute share each.

6. Submit (~5 min)

Packs collected for grading.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Templates pre-filled with section labels. Sentence frames for the caption. Allow oral defense in pair-share rather than whole-class share.
- **IEP/504:** Chunk the worksheet to one section per page; extended time. Allow audio submission of the caption.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what could break this chain?" section — name one node where a problem would ripple to the customer fastest. Previews PSIG's 5 Whys work.

Assessment

Summative: Pack graded on the Customer Research rubric (simplified). Anchor papers calibrate scoring.

Closure

Same as #6.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal: "What's one thing about my customer segment I still don't know that I want to figure out by Unit 2?"

Teacher notes

- A student's "producer" is also "supplier" and "seller." That's fine — coach to name the configuration: "I'm doing all three — that's a lot of jobs for one person." Sets up RACI in Unit 3.
- The peer share is high-leverage; protect the time even if the gallery walk runs short.

Lesson 4 — SOPs: Write the Recipe

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Build the system **Topic area:** Operations · standard operating procedures

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) and its purpose.
- Draft a 5-step SOP with a "check" for each step for a familiar process.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts — central to SOP writing.
- **CCSS-ELA W.6.4:** Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task.
- **CASEL Self-Management:** Goal-setting and follow-through.

Materials

- Cash Video #3 ("The same thing, the same way, every time") — 2:50.
- A printed SOP example: how to make a peanut-butter sandwich (deliberately too short — 3 vague steps).
- A second SOP: an excerpt from a real airline pre-flight checklist (kid version).
- SOP template (5 rows; each row has Step, Detail, Check).
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)** — a written, step-by-step recipe for how a business does something the same way every time.
- **Step** — one clear action.
- **Check** — how you know the step was done right.

Procedure

1. Engage — The Bad SOP (~8 min)

Project the deliberately bad SOP:

> *PB&J: 1) Get bread. 2) Put stuff on it. 3) Eat.*

Ask: "If I gave this to a robot, what would go wrong?" Pair-share, share-out 3 students. Surface: too vague. No checks. No counts.

Then project the airline checklist excerpt:

> *Step: Verify flap setting. Detail: Flaps to position 2. Check: Visually confirm green indicator. Pilot calls "Flaps two, indicator green."*

Ask: "What's different?" Specifics. Counts. Checks. Two people involved.

2. Explain — What an SOP Is and Why (~5 min)

Define. Add to Vocabulary Spine. Surface the year's frame: "SOPs aren't bureaucracy. They're how surgeons, pilots, chefs, and small business owners stop relying on memory. The same thing, the same way, every time."

Show Cash Video #3 if not played at week's start.

3. We Do — Sandwich SOP, Together (~12 min)

Together, fix the bad PB&J SOP. Aim for 5 steps with checks. Sample:

Step	Detail	Check
1	Get 2 slices of bread.	Both slices same size.
2	Open peanut butter jar.	Lid all the way off.
3	Spread 2 tablespoons PB on one slice.	Even coverage; no holes.
4	Spread 1 tablespoon jelly on other slice.	Even; not running off.
5	Press slices together.	Slices aligned.

Have students copy the table format into their Capstone Journal.

4. You Do — Capstone SOP, Draft 1 (~20 min)

Students pick one process in their Capstone (e.g., "how to take an order," "how to deliver a tutoring session," "how to make one bracelet"). Draft 5 steps with checks using the template.

Confer with as many students as possible. Common stuck points:

- Steps too big ("make the bracelet"). Coach: "Break that into 3 sub-steps."
- No checks. Coach: "How does the next person know step 1 was done right?"

5. Close — Pair Test (~5 min)

Pair students up. Each reads their SOP to the partner. Partner tries to pretend-do the steps. Reader watches for: did the partner pause, ask, or guess? Each pause is a place the SOP needs more detail.

End with the line: "An SOP is good when a stranger can follow it without asking. We'll keep refining."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Pre-printed template with one verb per row. Sentence frames: "First, **. Then,** . Check that ___." Cognates: SOP can be referred to as a recipe informally — most ELL students have the concept already.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce from 5 steps to 4. Larger-print template. Allow voice memo of the SOP first; transcribe with support.
- **Advanced learners:** Add "exception handling" — what's the SOP for when something goes wrong? (E.g., the bread is moldy; the customer changes their order halfway.) Introduces operational resilience.

Assessment

Formative: Conferring notes; pair-test observation. **Summative:** Draft SOP feeds Checkpoint 2 (Week 18).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

In the Capstone Journal: ask one adult at home (or a teacher) about an SOP they actually follow at work. Bring one detail Wednesday.

Teacher notes

- Some students will resist writing SOPs because "it's obvious." That's the lesson. Coach: "Then writing it should be easy. Show me." When they hit a vague spot, that's the value.
- A student writes an SOP for an unsafe process (anything involving heat, blades, chemicals). Coach toward a different process — Grade 6 SOPs should be safe-as-designed.

Lesson 5 — The Monthly Ledger and the Savings Rate

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 2 — Build the system **Topic area:** Money & financial literacy · ledger and ratio

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Build a one-month income/expense ledger for a hypothetical 12-year-old's small business.
- Calculate a savings rate as a percentage of income and explain why a small business might want one.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** Apply systematic decision making to a medium-term financial goal.
- **CCSS-Math 6.RP.A.3:** Use ratio and rate reasoning to solve real-world problems — central here.
- **CCSS-Math 6.SP.B.5:** Summarize numerical data sets in relation to their context.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 8:** People who own and run their own business take risks but also have the potential for higher rewards.

Materials

- Cash Video #4 ("Numbers tell you what happened; ratios tell you whether it's working") — 2:40.
- Pre-printed Ledger template — 4 columns: Date, Description, Income, Expense; bottom rows for totals and savings calculation.
- Calculator (or phone with calculator).
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Income** — money the business brings in.
- **Expense** — money the business pays out.
- **Ledger** — a record of income and expenses.
- **Savings rate** — the percentage of income the business sets aside (not spent on expenses).

Procedure

1. Engage — A Story About a Hypothetical 12-Year-Old (~8 min)

Tell the story:

> *"Pretend you know Jordan, age 12. Jordan runs a dog-walking service in their neighborhood. Last month, Jordan walked dogs for 4 different families. Jordan made $80 total. Jordan spent $5 on plastic bags and $4 on a new leash. Jordan's mom said: 'You should save some.' How much should Jordan save?"*

(Note the framing: for a hypothetical 12-year-old. Never ask about real family money.)

Pair-share. Surface: it depends on a rate. 10% would be $8. 25% would be $20.
There's no one right answer — but the question is real.

2. Explain — The Ledger and the Rate (~10 min)

Define ledger. Walk through the columns. Walk through Jordan's ledger:

Date	Description	Income	Expense
4/3	Walk Mrs. K's dog	$20	
4/5	Plastic bags		$5
4/10	Walk Sam's dog	$20	
4/12	Walk Mrs. K's dog	$20	
4/19	Walk Pat's dog	$20	
4/26	New leash		$4
	Totals:	**$80**	**$9**

Define savings rate: savings ÷ income, expressed as a percentage. Walk: if Jordan saves $8 of the $71 left over, savings rate is $8 / $80 = 10%.

Mini-lesson on percent-of math (recycle from 6th-grade math). The rate is a ratio. Surface: a savings rate is a goal — a target Jordan sets before the month, then checks against at end of month.

3. We Do — Build a Sample Ledger Together (~12 min)

Together: a hypothetical kid runs a homework-help service. Students fill in the ledger as you read transactions:

- Earned $15 helping a classmate.
- Spent $2 on photocopies.
- Earned $25 helping two more classmates.
- Spent $3 on snacks "for the brain."
- Earned $20.
- Spent $1 on a folder.

Compute: total income $60, total expenses $6, savings target 15% → $9. Feasible? Yes — there's $54 to allocate.

4. You Do — Capstone Ledger (~15 min)

Students build a one-month ledger for their own Capstone using realistic numbers (a dog-walking schedule, a tutoring schedule, an art-commission schedule). They invent the transactions; the math is real.

Required: - 8+ transactions across the month. - Income and expenses both present. - A savings rate target written first (before computing). - Final calculation of actual savings vs. target.

Confer.

5. Close — One Sentence (~5 min)

Exit ticket: "My Capstone's savings rate target is **%, because** ."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a printed reference card with the savings rate formula. Cognates: Spanish ingresos, gastos, tasa de ahorro. Pair on the We Do; independent on the Capstone ledger.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce from 8+ transactions to 6. Calculator allowed throughout. Pre-formatted ledger with rows numbered.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a sensitivity check — what happens to the savings target if income drops 20%? If expenses rise 30%? Compute both. Surfaces real-world budgeting tradeoffs.

Assessment

Formative: Ledger completion during You Do; conferring on Capstone application.
Summative: Ledger feeds Checkpoint 2 (Week 18).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Pick a hypothetical category of business (other than yours). Sketch a 5-transaction ledger and compute its savings rate. Bring Wednesday.

Teacher notes

- **Sensitivity flag:** A student says, "My family's savings rate is...". Redirect gently: "We're working with hypothetical 12-year-olds — let's keep your family's money private." If a student volunteers something concerning, validate briefly and refer to school counselor.
- A student picks a savings rate of 0%. That's a real choice — coach to defend it: "Why? What would happen the month a customer flakes?" Don't push toward a "right" answer.

Lesson 6 — Systems Pack: Checkpoint 2 Studio Day

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 80 minutes (block — Checkpoint day) **Unit:** 2 — Build the system **Topic area:** Synthesis · SOP + ledger

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Produce a Systems Pack: a polished 5-step SOP and a one-month ledger with a savings rate.
- Defend the Pack in a 3-minute peer share, including a "what would break the SOP" honest answer.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** Apply systematic decision making to a medium-term financial goal.
- **CCSS-Math 6.RP.A.3:** Use ratio and rate reasoning.
- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.6.4:** Present claims and findings.

Materials

- Polished SOP template.
- Polished Ledger template.
- Capstone Journal.
- Business Plan and Budget Project rubrics (simplified Grade 6 versions).
- Wall space.

Vocabulary

(Recycle: SOP, step, check, income, expense, ledger, savings rate.)

Procedure

1. Engage — Read the Rubrics Aloud (~5 min)

Project both rubrics. Read the criteria. Tell them: no surprises.

2. SOP Polish (~25 min)

Students take Lesson 4's draft SOP and polish to checkpoint quality:

- 5 steps minimum.
- A check for each step.
- A "what would break this" line at the bottom: the most likely failure point.

Confer with each student for 2 minutes.

3. Ledger Polish (~25 min)

Students take Lesson 5's draft Ledger and polish:

- 8+ transactions.
- Total income, total expenses, savings transfer.
- Savings rate target and actual, both shown.
- A 1-sentence note: "If income dropped 20%, my savings rate would become ___."

Confer.

4. Pair Defense (~15 min)

Students pair up. Each defends the Pack in 3 minutes — 90 seconds on the SOP, 90 seconds on the Ledger. The partner asks one question of each section.

Suggested questions on a card for the partner: - "What's the most likely place the SOP would break?" - "Why this savings rate, and not 5% higher or lower?"

5. Submit (~5 min)

Packs collected for grading.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** SOP and ledger templates pre-formatted with section labels. Sentence frames for defenses. Permit pair defense in native language with English summary.
- **IEP/504:** Chunk the work — SOP polish in one period, ledger polish in another, defense on a third day. Allow audio submission.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a second SOP for a different process. Show how the two interact (e.g., "how to take an order" and "how to fulfill an order" share customer data). Introduces process interaction.

Assessment

Summative: Pack graded on Business Plan rubric (Operations + Financial Logic criteria) plus Budget Project rubric.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Capstone Journal: "What part of my system am I least confident about, and what's one experiment I could run in Unit 3 to test it?"

Teacher notes

- Common pitfall: an SOP that's pretty but vague. Coach back to checks. Without a check, a step is just a sentence.
- Common pitfall: a ledger with all income and almost no expenses. Coach: every business has expenses. What are you forgetting? (Time? Materials? Permission slips?)

Lesson 7 — RACI: Who Does What, Who Decides

> *"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true."*
>
> — CASH

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Who does what **Topic area:** Leadership, teamwork · RACI

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define R, A, C, and I in a RACI chart.
- Fill out a RACI chart for a 4-task project with a 4-person team.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.6.2:** Write informative/explanatory texts.
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Negotiation, role clarity.
- **C3 D2.Eco.6.6-8:** Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices. (Loosely — labor is supplied; roles allocate it.)

Materials

- Cash Video #5 ("Roles are how teams stop arguing") — 2:35.
- Printed RACI template (4 columns × 4 rows).
- A printed bad-team-project story (1 page, provided).
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Responsible (R)** — the person who does the work.
- **Accountable (A)** — the one person who owns whether it gets done. (Only one A per task.)
- **Consulted (C)** — people whose input matters before the work is done.
- **Informed (I)** — people who need to know after the work is done.
- **RACI** — the chart itself.

Procedure

1. Engage — The Bad Team Project (~8 min)

Read aloud the bad-team-project story:

> *"Four kids — Maya, Ben, Priya, Luca — are running a school bake sale. Nobody talks about who does what. On Saturday, three of them show up with cookies. Nobody made flyers. Nobody handles money. Maya gets mad at Ben for not bringing flyers. Ben says he thought Priya was doing flyers. Priya says she did flyers — they're at home. The bake sale runs out of money to give change. They make $14."*

Ask: "What went wrong?" Pair-share. Surface: nobody knew who was responsible for what.

2. Explain — RACI in 5 Minutes (~5 min)

Define R, A, C, I. Show a RACI grid: tasks down the left, people across the top. In each cell, mark R, A, C, or I. The rule: every task needs one A. Multiple Rs are fine. Cs and Is are optional.

3. We Do — Fix the Bake Sale (~12 min)

Together, build a RACI for Maya, Ben, Priya, Luca. Tasks:

- Bake the cookies.
- Make and post flyers.
- Run the table on Saturday.
- Handle the money.

Possible RACI:

Task	Maya	Ben	Priya	Luca
Bake	A, R	R	R	R

Task	Maya	Ben	Priya	Luca
Flyers	C	A, R	R	I
Table	I	I	A, R	R
Money	I	I	I	A, R

Note: Every task has exactly one A. Multiple Rs are common. Cs are people whose input matters. Is are people who need to know.

4. You Do — Capstone RACI (~20 min)

Students work in teacher-assigned teams of 4. Each team picks one student's Capstone (or invents a 4-task project) and fills out a RACI. The 4 tasks must each have one A and at least one R.

Confer with each team. Common stuck point: students assign every task to the most popular kid as A. Coach: an A is accountable — they have to take the heat if it doesn't happen. Distribute As across the team.

5. Close — One Sentence (~5 min)

Exit ticket: "In my RACI, the task I'm most worried about is **, because** ."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide an oversized RACI template with cell-by-cell labels. Sentence frames for the close-out. Pair with a peer who's strong in English for the team work.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce from 4 tasks × 4 people to 3 × 3. Pre-printed grid with rows labeled. Allow verbal RACI walk-through with teacher first.
- **Advanced learners:** Add an "exception RACI" — what changes if one person is sick that day? Introduces operational resilience and the "single point of failure" concept.

Assessment

Formative: Team RACI charts; conferring notes. **Summative:** Feeds Checkpoint 3 (Week 28).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

In the Capstone Journal: pick a real recent group project (school or family). Sketch a RACI for what should have been the assignments. Bring Wednesday.

Teacher notes

- A student says "I'm responsible for everything." Coach: "If you're R for everything, who's accountable when you're sick? Pick one person to be your A on at least one task."
- A team can't agree on As. That's a leadership lesson. Coach: "An A doesn't have to do the work. They have to make sure it gets done. Who's willing to check?"

Lesson 8 — Legal but Sketchy: Drawing the Ethics Line

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Who does what **Topic area:** Ethics, safety, legal awareness

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Define and distinguish "fully fine," "legal but sketchy," and "over the line" with examples.
- Apply the three-category check to three sample cases and defend each call with one reason.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.6.1:** Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Considering ethical responsibility.
- **CEE Standard 2 (Buying Goods and Services), Grade 8:** People can use information from sellers and outside reviewers to compare products.

Materials

- 5 printed case cards. Each names a kid-relevant business action. Mix:
- Reselling a free school pencil for $1. (Legal but sketchy.)
- Charging a younger sibling for help with homework. (Borderline; depends on framing.)
- Selling a friendship bracelet for $5 with a true description. (Fully fine.)
- Telling a customer "everyone in school loves these" when only 3 people have tried it. (Legal but sketchy — possibly over the line.)
- Copying another student's craft design and selling it. (Over the line — taking someone's work.)
- Three poster sheets labeled FULLY FINE · LEGAL BUT SKETCHY · OVER THE LINE.
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Fully fine** — honest, legal, no harm to anyone.
- **Legal but sketchy** — technically not against the law, but a customer or a friend would feel taken if they knew.
- **Over the line** — actually unfair, dishonest, or against rules — even if "everyone does it."

Procedure

1. Engage — Sort the First Three Cards (~10 min)

Read the first three cases aloud. As a class, sort onto the three posters. Collect reasons as students argue. Don't tell them which is right; surface the criteria they use:

- "Did the customer know?"
- "Could the customer have said no?"
- "Did anyone get hurt?"
- "Is this how I'd want to be treated?"

2. Explain — The Three Categories (~5 min)

Define the three. Add to Vocabulary Spine. State the rule: "Some things are clearly fine. Some are clearly over the line. The interesting space is in the middle — legal but sketchy. That's where you have to think."

3. Apply — Pair Analysis on Cards 4 and 5 (~15 min)

In pairs, students take cards 4 and 5. They sort and write a 1–2 sentence verdict: which category, why. Push for which criterion — surface that students might use different criteria and reach different verdicts. That's real ethics.

4. Discuss — Where's Your Line? (~10 min)

Whole class. Project case 4 (the "everyone loves these" claim). Run a four-corners activity:

- "Fully fine — it's just marketing."
- "Legal but sketchy — leans fine."
- "Legal but sketchy — leans over the line."
- "Over the line — it's a lie."

Students go to their corner. One spokesperson per corner gives a 30-second case. Then offer a chance to switch.

Don't tell them what's right. Let the discussion surface the criteria.

5. Close — Capstone Ethics Pledge (~10 min)

In the Capstone Journal:

- In my Capstone, I will not [**_] because [**_].
- In my Capstone, I will [**_] because [**_].
- If a friend pushed me to "stretch the truth," I would [____].

End class.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide simplified case cards with bolded key phrases. Cognates where possible. Sentence frames for the verdicts. Allow native-language argument with English summary.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce from 5 cases to 3. Pre-printed verdict template with checkboxes for the three categories.
- **Advanced learners:** Write a sixth case from scratch — design the trickiest "legal but sketchy" case the class has seen yet. Defend why each category is plausible.

Assessment

Formative: Sort, pair analysis, four-corners participation. **Summative:** Pledge feeds Checkpoint 3 (Week 28).

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

In the Capstone Journal: find one real ad or product that you'd put in "legal but sketchy." Write 2 sentences on why.

Teacher notes

- **Sensitivity flag:** Stay in the middle-school lane. If a student brings up an adult ethics issue (substance use, dating manipulation), validate briefly and redirect: "That's a real question, and it's bigger than this class. Let's stay with kid-business cases for now."
- A student declares "everything is sketchy in business." Validate the instinct, then push: "Then how do you tell the difference between a business you'd buy from and one you wouldn't? That's the line we're learning to draw."

Lesson 9 — The 5 Whys: Past the First Answer

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 4 — Run the stand-up **Topic area:** Problem solving · root cause

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Run a "5 Whys" sequence on a business problem to find a possible root cause.
- Distinguish a root cause from a surface cause with one example each.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA W.6.1:** Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.6.1:** Engage effectively in collaborative discussions.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Recognize one's own assumptions.

Materials

- Cash Video #7 ("The first answer is rarely the real answer") — 2:30.
- A printed "5 Whys" template (5 numbered rows).
- A bad-day case: "On Saturday, the bake sale only made $14, half of last week's number. Why?"
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Surface cause** — the first reason you think of for a problem.
- **Root cause** — the deeper reason that, if fixed, would actually prevent the problem.
- **5 Whys** — asking "why" five times in a row to push past surface to root.

Procedure

1. Engage — One Bad Saturday (~8 min)

Tell the bake-sale story (or Cash Video #7). Pair-share: "Why did sales drop?" Collect 5 surface answers from the class:

- Fewer people came.
- The cookies were stale.
- It was cold outside.
- We didn't have flyers.
- The other class did a fundraiser too.

Surface that these are all surface answers — they don't tell you what to do differently next week.

2. Explain — The 5 Whys (~5 min)

Define. Walk through the move:

- Pick one surface cause: "Fewer people came."
- Ask why. Answer: "Nobody saw the bake sale was happening."
- Ask why. Answer: "We didn't post flyers in time."
- Ask why. Answer: "Priya took the flyers home Friday."
- Ask why. Answer: "Nobody asked Priya to post them — there was no plan for who posts when."
- Ask why. Answer: "We didn't have a RACI for the flyer task."

The fifth answer is the root cause. It's also fixable — next week, we make a RACI.

3. We Do — Run the 5 Whys on a Different Surface Cause (~12 min)

Together, run the 5 Whys on "the cookies were stale." Expect students to land on root causes like "we didn't have an SOP for when to bake them" or "we didn't have a check that they were fresh on Saturday morning."

Surface: the root cause often points back to a system (an SOP, a RACI). That's not coincidence. Most business problems are systems problems.

4. You Do — Capstone 5 Whys (~20 min)

In the Capstone Journal, each student picks a hypothetical bad day for their venture (you can offer prompts: "Sales dropped 50% on a Tuesday." "A customer left a one-word complaint." "Your team missed a deadline."). Run the 5 Whys to a possible root cause.

Confer with as many students as possible. Common stuck point: students give up after 3 whys. Coach: "Push one more. The boring answer is usually the right one."

5. Close — Pair Test (~5 min)

Pair students. Each shares their 5th why. Partner asks: "If you fixed this root cause, would the problem actually go away?" If yes, good 5 Whys. If no, push deeper.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Pre-printed 5-row template. Sentence frames: "Why did ___ happen? Because ___." Allow native-language drafting with English finalization.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce from 5 whys to 3 whys for the first attempt; build to 5 over multiple sessions. Allow verbal walk-through with the teacher.
- **Advanced learners:** After landing on a root cause, propose a system change (a new SOP, a RACI update, a stand-up question) that would prevent the problem. Connects 5 Whys to all of Units 2–3.

Assessment

Formative: Pair-test responses. **Summative:** 5 Whys log feeds the final Stand-up Pack at Checkpoint 4.

Closure

Same as #5.

Homework / Extension

Use the 5 Whys on a non-business problem (e.g., "I forgot my homework"). Bring Friday — see if the technique works outside business.

Teacher notes

- A student lands on "because I'm bad at this" or "because I'm lazy" as a root cause. Coach: that's a self-blame, not a root cause. Push past — the root cause is usually a system gap, not a person.
- A student lands on a root cause that blames a real classmate by name. Coach toward the system: "What about the system let that happen? A RACI would have made it clear."

Lesson 10 — Capstone Defense Day

"You don't have to know everything. You have to know one number."

— CASH

Grade band: 6-8 **Time:** 90 minutes (block — or two periods) **Unit:** Capstone synthesis
Topic area: Reflection · public presentation · year-long synthesis

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Deliver a 3–4 minute Capstone Defense covering: (a) value chain + segment, (b) SOP + ledger, (c) RACI + ethics pledge, (d) one stand-up adjustment.
- Respond to one panel question citing specific evidence from the year's work.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA SL.6.4:** Present claims and findings, sequencing ideas logically.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.6.5:** Include multimedia components and visual displays.

- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 8-1:** Apply systematic decision making.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness + Responsible Decision-Making.**

Materials

- Each student's full Capstone Journal and Activity Book.
- Defense slides or poster (built in Week 35).
- Pitch Presentation rubric (Grade 5–6 simplified version — 5 criteria, no Q&A handling at this band).
- Panel of 3–4 evaluators (other teachers, older students, parents, community members).
- Timer.

Vocabulary

(All previously introduced — recycle.)

Procedure

1. Engage — 60-Second Warm-Up (~10 min)

Pair students. Each gives a 60-second version of their Capstone to their partner. Partner asks one question. Repeat with a new partner. (Two rounds — confidence warm-up before the panel.)

2. Set the Norms (~5 min)

State the day's norms:

- Each student gets 3–4 minutes for the defense + 1 minute for one panel question.
- The panel is curious, not adversarial.
- The audience listens silently and writes one "I noticed..." per presenter.

Show the rubric one more time.

3. Defenses (~55 min, ~12–15 students at 4–5 min each; longer block or split day for more)

Each student delivers the defense with this structure:

- **The chain + segment (45 sec):** "My venture is X. The chain goes from [supplier] to me to [customer], who is [3 things known]."
- **The system (60 sec):** "My SOP is [name]. Five steps. The check that matters most is [Y]. My ledger had a savings rate of [Z]%."
- **The roles + ethics (45 sec):** "My RACI assigns [task] to [person] as A. My ethics pledge is [Z]."

- **The adjustment (45 sec):** "Two weeks of stand-ups. The biggest stuck was [X]. I adjusted by [Y]. Result: [Z]."
- **What I learned about myself (45 sec):** "The biggest thing I got wrong was [X]. The system that helped most was [Y]."

Then 1 minute for one panel question.

4. Audience Reflection (~5 min)

Each audience member completes a 1-question card: "One thing I noticed across many defenses today: __." Collect.

5. Final Cash Reflection (~10 min)

Play Cash Video #8 — the year-end "Systems Thinker" summary. Students write a final Capstone Journal entry:

- The biggest thing I learned this year was [____].
- One thing I'd tell next year's Grade 6 student is [____].
- I'm proud of [____].
- I'm going to keep working on [____].

6. Close (~5 min)

Two volunteers share their final journal entries. Acknowledge the year's work. Hand back any artifacts students brought home.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Allow visuals to carry more weight in the defense — a poster, props, charts. Sentence frames for the panel question. Permit a same-language peer to translate panel questions on the spot if needed.
- **IEP/504:** Allow the defense to be delivered in shorter chunks if 4 min is overwhelming — 1-minute mini-segments with 30-second pauses. Permit a printed script. Audio-record version submitted in advance is also acceptable.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what I'd build next" segment — what's the next system you'd add to this venture? Push for specificity.

Assessment

Summative: Defense graded on Pitch Presentation rubric (Grade 5–6 simplified). Capstone Journal across the year is a separate portfolio grade using the Reflection Writing rubric.

Closure

Same as #6.

Homework / Extension

(End of year — none required.)

Teacher notes

- Panel members need a 5-minute briefing before defenses start. Cover: rubric, norms, what to ask. Provide 3 sample questions: "What was the most likely place your SOP would break? Why this savings rate? What did you change after a stand-up?"
- Some students will be very nervous. The 60-second warm-up matters.
- This defense is a warm-up for Grade 7's longer defense. Praise the structure, not the polish.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 6 SOPs and misconceptions

Three full SOP worked examples (add to Lesson 4 — SOPs: Write the Recipe)

The original lesson teaches the form. Add three end-to-end SOPs to model the rigor.

SOP A — Taking an order at a kid-run snack stand

Purpose: Make sure every customer gets what they ordered, gets the right change, and feels welcomed.

Steps:

1. **Greet the customer.** Make eye contact. Say: "Hi! Welcome to [stand name]. What would you like?" Check: customer responded.
2. **Repeat the order back.** "That's a [item], for [price]. Did I get that right?" Check: customer confirmed.
3. **Take payment.** Receive cash. Count out loud: "That's a five. So your change is..." Compute change. Check: amount on the change tray equals what's owed.
4. **Hand over the item.** Place item in customer's hand or bag. "Here you go!" Check: item delivered.
5. **Say thank you.** "Thanks for stopping by. See you next time." Check: customer acknowledged.

Common stuck point: new workers skip step 2. Coach: "Repeating the order back is the cheap insurance that catches mistakes."

SOP B — Restocking the snack stand

Purpose: Make sure the stand stays stocked without running out and without over-buying.

Steps:

1. **Count what's on the table.** Write the count for each item. Check: count matches inventory log.
2. **Compare to the start-of-day count.** Subtract. The difference is "sold today." Check: difference is reasonable.
3. **Pick the item with the lowest remaining stock.** Restock first.
4. **Bring the new stock from the back.** Check: count out the items as you place them.
5. **Update the inventory log.** Write: date, item, "added X." Check: log is current.

SOP C — Closing the snack stand at the end of the day

Purpose: Leave the stand clean and the cash counted, ready for tomorrow.

Steps:

1. **Count the cash.** Tally bills and coins separately. Write the total. Check: total matches expected (start cash + sold today – any returns).
2. **Wipe down the table.** Use the spray and the cloth in the closing kit. Check: table is dry.
3. **Cover the stand.** Drape the cloth. Check: cloth is on.
4. **Lock the cash box.** Move to the secure spot. Check: box is locked.
5. **Sign the closing log.** Date, your name, total cash. Check: log signed.

Coach the meta-lesson: "An SOP is what makes you replaceable. That sounds bad. It's actually good — it means the business doesn't fall apart when you're sick. It's how a business goes from one person to two."

Common Misconceptions (Grade 6)

Kid belief	What's actually true	How to coach
"If we're friends, we don't need a RACI."	Friends fight more, not less, when roles are unclear. RACI prevents the fight before it starts.	"Last year, when did you and a friend disagree about who was supposed to do what? RACI exists for that."
"An SOP is just a checklist."	An SOP has a check at each step. A checklist is a list of things to do; an SOP also tells you how to know you did it right.	"What's the check on step 3? How do you know it's done?"
"5 Whys is just asking 'why' five times."	5 Whys is asking "why" until you reach a root cause that's actionable. Sometimes that's 3, sometimes 7. Five is the typical landing zone.	"At what 'why' did you find something you could actually fix?"

Kid belief	What's actually true	How to coach
"Savings rate is what you have left over."	Savings rate is what you set aside first, before everything else. Pay yourself first; spend from what's left.	"If you wait until the end of the month to save, the savings won't be there. Savings rate is the first line of the ledger."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Common Misconceptions (Grade 6)

Common kid-belief	Reality	Coaching move
"RACI is too formal for a kid project."	RACI prevents the "I thought you were doing it" failure that kills real teams. The kid version is just as useful.	Run a 4-task project where two students think both are "Responsible." Have them fix it with a RACI table.
"An SOP is for boring stuff."	An SOP is for anything you want done the same way every time — taking an order, restocking, closing the day. SOPs make you faster.	Time a student doing "restock" twice — once without SOP, once with. The SOP version is faster and more complete.
"5 Whys is just asking why a lot."	5 Whys is systematic — it follows the causal chain. The 5th why is often the real problem (e.g., "we sold less today" → "store was empty after lunch" → "we ran out of cups" → "we didnt restock at noon" → "we had no SOP for restocking" → real problem: no SOP).	Walk a real "we sold less today" 5 Whys end-to-end. The 5th why is the SOP gap.
"A monthly ledger is just adding up money."	A ledger tracks income and expenses and a savings rate. The savings rate (% of income set aside) is the real adult skill.	Show a hypothetical 12-year-olds month: income $200, expenses $150, savings $50 = 25% savings rate. Compare to: income $200, expenses $190, savings $10 = 5% savings rate.
"Legal-but-sketchy is fine because its legal."	Legal-but-sketchy means a customer would feel taken even though no law was broken. Three-tier ethics: fully fine / legal-but-sketchy / over the line.	Walk through 3 cases. Have students place each on the three-tier line and defend.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Worked Examples for SOP Lesson

Three SOPs end-to-end:

SOP 1: Take an Order (5-step). 1. Greet the customer ("Hi, what can I get you?"). 2. Repeat the order back ("One lemonade, $1, anything else?"). 3. Take the money. Count it back ("From $5, your change is $4."). 4. Make the order. 5. Hand it over with a thank-you. Mark the sale on the inventory tracker.

SOP 2: Restock the Stand (5-step). 1. Check the inventory tracker. Note any item below 5 units. 2. Refill from supply box. Mark refilled on tracker. 3. Wipe the counter. Replace any used cups. 4. Update the price sign if anything changed. 5. Tell the cashier "stand restocked."

SOP 3: Close the Day (5-step). 1. Count remaining inventory. Mark on tracker. 2. Count the cash drawer. Match to expected total (sales + starting cash). 3. Note any discrepancy. Investigate before leaving. 4. Pack up supplies, clean the counter. 5. Write one sentence in the journal: "Today we sold **; biggest issue was** ."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Multi-Class Branching Scenario (Grade 6)

"The cookie business — Maya makes; Tomas changes the recipe." A 3-day branching scenario.

- **Day 1.** Maya runs production for the after-school cookie business. Tomas keeps changing the recipe between batches. Sales are inconsistent. Run a 5 Whys: why are sales inconsistent? → Tomas changes the recipe → no SOP → no agreement on whos Responsible.
- **Day 2.** Build a RACI for "recipe changes." Whos R (Responsible) — Maya. Whos A (Accountable) — the team. Whos C (Consulted) — Tomas. Whos I (Informed) — Maya.
- **Day 3.** Write the SOP for "recipe approval" — 5 steps that prevent the next fight.

This branching practices BAVC (value chain — production), PSIG (5 Whys), OSO (SOP + RACI), LTO (responsibility clarity), ESL (legal-but-sketchy: was Tomass behavior fair to Maya and to customers?), LRCI (weekly stand-up to prevent recurrence).

ROUND 2 PATCH — Teacher Move Set (Grade 6)

- **Team has a fight in the team meeting.** Say: "Lets pause. Run a 5 Whys on the fight. What was it really about? RACI confusion is often the answer."
- **Student writes an SOP that skips the customer-facing step.** Say: "Walk me through this with a customer in front of you. Wheres the customer in your SOP?"
- **Student writes a 5 Whys that loops back on itself.** Say: "Each why should add a new cause. If youre repeating, youve hit the root cause. Stop."

- **Student says "RACI is dumb because we already know who does what."** Say: "Lets check. Whos Responsible for cleanup? Whos Accountable if it doesnt happen? Are those the same person?" Often theyre not.
- **Student writes a ledger that shows only income.** Say: "Whats the expense side? Lemons? Cups? Bus fare to get there? List them."

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."

— CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 6 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 6 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist. The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 2 (Spending & Saving) 8-1	Identify ways to deposit, store, and pay for goods and services.
CCSS-ELA SL.6.1	Engage effectively in collaborative discussions; build on others' ideas.
CASEL Self-Management	Set and monitor goals; manage time.
C3 D2.Eco.4.6-8	Describe the role of competition in the determination of prices and wages.
CASEL Relationship Skills	Establish and maintain healthy relationships; communicate effectively.
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-2	Identify ways that consumers may avoid making poor decisions.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."

— CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Roles That Save Time

Maya runs a small backyard car-wash on Saturdays with three friends. Last weekend, every kid did every job. They washed nine cars in five hours. They argued twice. Two cars came out streaky. Maya's notebook says: "Same kid greeted, soaped, rinsed, and took the money. Bottleneck: the towel-dry. Decision: split into roles."

This week, Maya assigns roles. Greeter, soaper, rinser, dryer, money. They wash twelve cars in five hours. Zero arguments. No streaks. Same humans. Different system.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."

— CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"Most adults run their lives without a system. You won't."

— CASH, GRADE 6